

SO YOU WANT TO SELL

BRANDED MERCH

Companion workbook

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Sixteen exercises for finding clients, developing recommendations, winning orders and growing relationships.

Use a fresh copy for each opportunity. These are the same exercises placed alongside the chapters in the book, formatted here on US Letter pages for printing and writing.

The pricing exercise includes an answer page. For the other exercises, record what the client actually said, identify what is still open and agree on the next action.

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Find the worksheet you need

The chapter number refers to the main book. The page number refers to this companion.

1. Find an opening and earn a conversation	Ch. 4	3
2. Turn a buyer question into useful content	Ch. 5	4
3. Ask before you recommend	Ch. 6	5
4. Build an idea you can deliver	Ch. 8	6
5. Make the deck useful in a meeting	Ch. 9	7
6. Know what the whole order costs	Ch. 10	8
7. Work through the objection	Ch. 11	9
8. Help the buyer get the order approved	Ch. 12	10
9. Decide whether to bid	Ch. 13	11
10. Turn the yes into clear instructions	Ch. 14	12
11. Keep delivery and recovery moving	Ch. 15	13
12. Make the visit worth taking	Ch. 16	14
13. Earn the next project and introduction	Ch. 17	15
14. Scope the merch store	Ch. 18	16
15. Put one prompt to work	Ch. 19	17
16. Plan the week and learn from it	Ch. 21	18
Pricing exercise answers		19

Find an opening and earn a conversation

Work on one real prospect. Write the reason this person would care before writing your introduction.

My niche, the account and the buyer I want to help

Observed trigger and what I still need to confirm

My opening message and the small next step I will ask for

A follow-up with new information, channel and proposed date

If the answer is not yet: reason, buying window and agreed next contact

Current stage, last response and the next action I own

If the buyer answers, adjust the plan. Record people separately from the number of attempts.

Turn a buyer question into useful content

Choose a real question you can discuss publicly. Use the worked example in Chapter 5 as a guide, then make this sound like you.

Who I want to help and the question they are asking

My point of view and the decision it helps them make

The example, product detail or evidence I can share accurately

My opening and the practical takeaway for the reader

Format, publishing date and a relevant follow-up conversation

What came back: replies, introductions, projects and the next step

A reaction is not a qualified project. Ask how people found you and record the full story.

Ask before you recommend

Take notes as the conversation develops. Mark the answer that changes your recommendation, then play back what you heard.

What are they trying to accomplish, and who will receive the merch?

Why this product? What worked or disappointed them before?

What should recipients do, feel or remember?

Quantity and total budget, including what the budget must cover

In-hands date, delivery locations and practical constraints

Who approves what, and what still needs an answer?

Your next sentence: 'Here is what I heard. Have I got that right?'

Build an idea you can deliver

Use one page per concept. Compare the completed pages before choosing what to put in the deck.

The product, audience and reason this idea answers the brief

Decoration, placement and packaging that make it work

Supplier contacts, including any specialist outside our usual sources

Stock by required variant, date checked and any reservation

Full quoted scope, cost, minimum and useful next price break

Development, approvals, production and delivery: dates and open questions

Call the supplier with the brief. Ask what the website does not tell you.

Make the deck useful in a meeting

Prepare the conversation as carefully as the slides. The buyer may use this deck again with colleagues.

How the deck reflects this brand and its actual audience

My lead recommendation and the reason behind it

Details the buyer needs: scope, price breaks, timing and delivery

Questions I will ask live, including reactions and sample requests

The buyer's goals, KPIs and what their internal approver needs

The decision we reached and my email recap with the next step

Whenever possible, present live. Send the deck afterward with the useful parts of the conversation.

Know what the whole order costs

These practice figures are illustrative and exclude tax. For this exercise, all listed costs count toward gross profit.

250 blanks at \$6 each; decoration at \$1.20 each; \$50 setup; \$150 freight. Sell the complete order for \$3,000. Then reduce the selling price by 10%, keeping costs unchanged.

Original total cost and gross profit: show the arithmetic

Original gross margin and markup: show each denominator

Discounted revenue, gross profit and gross margin

What percentage of the original gross profit did the discount remove?

A real quote: costs and delivery charges I still need to establish

One scope change I can offer instead of an unexplained discount

Answers are in the back under Worksheet 6: calculation answers. A lower unit price can still produce a higher total bill.

Work through the objection

Record the buyer's actual words. A useful response starts with finding out what the concern means.

What the buyer said, as closely as I can remember it

My question to understand the concern and what I learned

The comparison, evidence or option that answers that concern

What remains unresolved and who is part of the decision

The next action the buyer and I agreed to, with dates

My follow-up if the decision stalls

If the buyer has an incumbent, look for a useful first opening. Do not assume they need to replace a relationship they value.

Help the buyer get the order approved

Map the decisions while you are earning the order. Identify who can make each decision and what they still need. Use your company's process.

Decision	Approver and information needed	Owner	Due and status
Product choice			
Budget			
Artwork			
Vendor setup			
Purchase authorization			

The next decision I will request, from whom and by when

The message or meeting that will help them make that decision

This map helps secure approval. Worksheet 10 checks the final instructions before release.

Decide whether to bid

Read the actual request. Discuss the opportunity with the colleagues who would deliver the work.

Why the buyer is running this process and how they will evaluate us

Mandatory requirements we meet and the gaps that need a decision

Our evidence: relevant work, capacity and a credible delivery approach

Relationship or chance to build one: permitted meetings and questions

Commercial fit, response time and outside expense; who approves them

Bid, clarify or pass: the reasons, owner and next date

After the result, record the feedback. Use it to improve the next decision, not just the next presentation.

Turn the yes into clear instructions

Use this beside the signed order and your company's approval process. Record the final versions the team will use.

Product, quantity, colors, sizes and final order reference

Artwork, decoration, dimensions, placement and final proof reference

Sample or proof reviewed: approver, date and any explained limitation

Packaging, kitting and destinations with receiving instructions

Agreed total, payment terms, estimates and exclusions

Approval, production and in-hands dates, with owners and change process

A virtual used to present an idea may differ from the final production proof. Check which version was approved.

Keep delivery and recovery moving

Use for an active order. If something changes, establish the facts and keep the client informed while you work on the solution.

Latest production or QC update, who confirmed it and when

Tracking, expected arrival and the person receiving the goods

Any problem: known facts, missing information and client impact

Practical options, with timing, cost and what the client needs to decide

Who is doing what, and when I promised the next client update

After arrival: reception, event feedback and what we will improve

Track the tracking number. When the order arrives, ask how the products were received and invite the client to send pictures.

Make the visit worth taking

Plan time with a client or prospect. A useful visit can include product work, a meal and space to get to know one another.

Who I want to see and why meeting now would be useful

What they are working on and what I want to understand

Relevant samples and additional work to have ready if interest changes

The invitation, setting and people to include

What I learned about the person and their business

My follow-through: promises, useful introductions and next contact

Let the relationship develop naturally. Make time to talk about something besides the order.

Earn the next project and introduction

Use what you learned from the last order to plan the next useful conversation. Give store discovery its own page in Worksheet 14.

What worked in the last project and what the client wants to change

Next occasion and when planning and buying decisions begin

Another department we could help, and why the work is relevant

The introduction I will request and a short note they can forward

The next project or program and how the buyer will judge its usefulness

Decision owner, next conversation and date

Ask for an introduction after understanding the next need. Give your contact a useful reason to make it.

Scope the merch store

Complete this with the buyer and your ecommerce or fulfillment colleague before promising a program. Mark any answer that still needs confirmation.

Purpose, users and what a successful store should accomplish

Who can order, who pays and the proposed operating model

Products, inventory owner, replenishment and remaining-stock responsibility

Setup and ongoing costs, funding and the buyer's approvals

Fulfillment timing, destinations, support and returns

Technology or data review, open questions, owners and next decision

A storefront needs an operating plan. Confirm responsibilities before putting the promise in the proposal.

Put one prompt to work

Choose one job on your list today. Try the relevant prompt, then use this page to make the result more useful. Keep confidential details in your approved work system.

The job and the prompt: what do I need to accomplish, and which prompt will I use?

What I will give it: which brief, sources, examples or confirmed details does it need?

What the first answer missed: what was useful, generic, incorrect or still unanswered?

What I will change and verify: how will I improve the instruction, and who can confirm the facts?

What happens next: what will I do with the result, by when, and how will it help the client?

If AI saves you an hour, you do not have to spend it making more content about AI. Go talk to someone who might need your help.

Plan the week and learn from it

Protect time for new business and current clients. Use the grid for activity, then explain what the work produced.

Activity this week	Planned	Actual
Contact attempts		
Unique people contacted		
Conversations held		
Qualified projects added		
Proposals presented		
Orders won		

Priority opportunities and the next action for each

Meetings, proposals, orders and client promises with dates

A useful piece of content and the buyer question it answers

Where work stalled, what I learned and what I will change

Track attempts and people separately. Give open opportunities time to develop; record their next decision.

Worksheet 6 calculation answers

Total cost is $(250 \times \$6) + (250 \times \$1.20) + \$50 + \$150 = \$2,000$.

At the original \$3,000 selling price, gross profit is $\$3,000 - \$2,000 = \$1,000$. Gross margin is $\$1,000 \div \$3,000 = 33.3\%$. Markup is $\$1,000 \div \$2,000 = 50\%$. The denominators are different.

After a 10% selling-price reduction, revenue is $\$3,000 \times 0.90 = \$2,700$. Gross profit is $\$2,700 - \$2,000 = \$700$. Gross margin is $\$700 \div \$2,700 =$ approximately 25.9%.

The discount removes \$300 of the original \$1,000 gross profit: $\$300 \div \$1,000 = 30\%$. A 10% price reduction has removed 30% of gross profit in this example.

Possible scope changes depend on the brief. You might quote one imprint location instead of two, simplify packaging or compare a different blank. Recalculate the full cost and explain the tradeoff before recommending a change. Removing an undisclosed charge is not a scope change.

For a real quote, use the company's cost classifications and approved commercial terms. This exercise excludes tax and treats every listed cost as part of the order's cost for calculating gross profit.